

E019

Cybersecurity Strategy

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A logistics firm with 1,200 employees values its customer database at \$2,000,000. A ransomware event would damage 25% of that value, and the firm expects such an event once every five years. The CISO joined from a bank last spring. What is the annualized loss expectancy?

- A. \$100,000
- B. \$500,000
- C. \$2,500,000
- D. \$400,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A risk has an SLE of \$240,000 and an ALE of \$60,000. What is its annualized rate of occurrence?

- A. It cannot be found without the asset value.
- B. 4
- C. 1, because every risk is assumed to happen once a year.
- D. 0.25 (about once every four years)

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A regional clinic group buys a cyber insurance policy that covers breach notification and legal costs. The broker is a family friend of the board chair, and the premium is paid quarterly. Which risk treatment is this?

- A. Risk avoidance.
- B. Risk acceptance, because the clinic still pays a premium.
- C. Risk transfer.
- D. Risk mitigation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Leadership decides that a legacy file-sharing service is too risky and shuts it down permanently rather than securing it. Which treatment did they choose?

- A.** Transfer.
- B.** Mitigation.
- C.** Acceptance.
- D.** Avoidance.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A retailer's current ALE for payment-data breaches is \$150,000. A proposed monitoring service would cut ALE to \$30,000 and costs \$70,000 a year. The vendor is used by three of the retailer's competitors. What is the control's net annual value?

- A.** \$120,000 a year.
- B.** \$50,000 a year, so it is justified.
- C.** Not justified, because \$70,000 is more than the \$30,000 left over.
- D.** -\$50,000 a year, so it loses money.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A control would reduce ALE from \$90,000 to \$20,000. What is the most the organization should pay per year for it?

- A.** \$70,000
- B.** \$90,000
- C.** \$20,000
- D.** \$110,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

An insurance company has modern email filtering and endpoint protection, yet staff keep approving fake invoice requests. Employees complete a 20-minute training each January. The company recently moved to a new headquarters building. What should the strategy change first?

- A. Build ongoing reinforcement and a clear verification process for payment requests, backed by leadership.
- B. Review physical security at the new building.
- C. Buy a second email filter from another vendor.
- D. Make the January training longer, which will fully solve the problem.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A university security office writes a document that says all laptops must use full-disk encryption with AES-256 and names the approved tool. The document was drafted over the summer by two analysts. What type of document is this?

- A. A policy.
- B. A standard.
- C. A guideline.
- D. A procedure.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which statement belongs in a policy rather than in a standard or procedure?

- A. "Open the settings panel, select Encryption, and click Enable."
- B. "Company data on portable devices must be protected from unauthorized disclosure."
- C. "Laptops must use AES-256 full-disk encryption with the approved tool."
- D. "Staff should consider a privacy screen when working in public."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A manufacturer relies on a strong firewall at the network edge. It has no log review and no tested restore process. The firewall appliance cost \$85,000 and was installed by a well-known integrator. Which gap is most important to name in the strategy?

- A.** It lacks preventive controls.
- B.** A strong firewall is enough if configured correctly.
- C.** The firewall should be replaced with a more expensive model.
- D.** It lacks detective and corrective controls, so a breach past the firewall would go unseen and unrecovered.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A city government using NIST CSF 2.0 assigns executive roles for cybersecurity, sets its risk appetite, and requires suppliers to meet security terms. The city's population grew 6% this decade. Which function do these activities belong to?

- A.** Respond.
- B.** Identify.
- C.** Govern.
- D.** Protect.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A gap analysis at a mid-size bank shows no multifactor authentication for remote access (high risk, low cost), an aging SIEM (medium risk, high cost), and an interest in an AI threat-hunting tool a vendor demoed at a golf outing. Budget covers only one item this quarter. What belongs first on the roadmap?

- A.** All three at once so no gap remains.
- B.** The AI threat-hunting tool, because it is the most advanced.
- C.** Multifactor authentication for remote access.
- D.** Replacing the SIEM, because the most expensive item signals the biggest risk.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A logistics firm with 1,200 employees values its customer database at \$2,000,000. A ransomware event would damage 25% of that value, and the firm expects such an event once every five years. ~~The CISO joined from a bank last spring.~~ What is the annualized loss expectancy?

Target word: ALE **Decides:** SLE \$500,000 × ARO 0.2.

A	Correct	$\$2,000,000 \times 25\% = \$500,000$ SLE; $\times 0.2 = \$100,000$.
B	Dropped element	That is the SLE; it leaves out the annual rate.
C	Inverted operation	Divides SLE by ARO instead of multiplying.
D	Wrong stem number	Multiplies the full asset value by ARO, skipping the exposure factor.

2. Answer D Concept 1 · transfer

A risk has an SLE of \$240,000 and an ALE of \$60,000. What is its annualized rate of occurrence?

Target word: solve for ARO **Decides:** ARO = ALE / SLE.

A	Adjacent category	Asset value is only needed to get SLE, which is already given.
B	Inverted operation	Divides SLE by ALE.
C	Absolute language	ARO is estimated per risk; it is not fixed at 1.
D	Correct	$\$60,000 / \$240,000 = 0.25$.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A regional clinic group buys a cyber insurance policy that covers breach notification and legal costs. ~~The broker is a family friend of the board chair, and the premium is paid quarterly.~~ Which risk treatment is this?

Target word: name the treatment **Decides:** Insurance shifts financial impact to a third party.

A	Adjacent category	Avoidance means stopping the risky activity.
B	Camouflage	The payment schedule does not change the treatment type.
C	Correct	Insurance moves the financial consequence to the insurer.
D	Confusion set	Mitigation lowers likelihood or impact of the event itself; insurance does not stop a breach.

4. Answer D Concept 2 · transfer

Leadership decides that a legacy file-sharing service is too risky and shuts it down permanently rather than securing it. Which treatment did they choose?

Target word: treatment from the action **Decides:** The risky activity was stopped.

A	Confusion set	No third party took on the impact.
B	Inverted operation	Mitigation would secure the service and keep it running.
C	Adjacent category	Acceptance keeps the activity and its risk as-is.
D	Correct	Ending the activity removes the risk.

5. Answer B Concept 3

A retailer's current ALE for payment-data breaches is \$150,000. A proposed monitoring service would cut ALE to \$30,000 and costs \$70,000 a year. ~~The vendor is used by three of the retailer's competitors.~~ What is the control's net annual value?

Target word: net annual value of the control **Decides:** $\$150,000 - \$30,000 - \$70,000$.

A	Dropped element	Ignores the control's annual cost.
B	Correct	ALE reduction \$120,000 minus cost \$70,000 = \$50,000.
C	Confusion set	Compares cost to residual ALE instead of to the reduction.
D	Inverted operation	Subtracts in the wrong direction.

6. Answer A Concept 3 · transfer

A control would reduce ALE from \$90,000 to \$20,000. What is the most the organization should pay per year for it?

Target word: solve for maximum control cost **Decides:** Maximum cost = ALE reduction.

A	Correct	$\$90,000 - \$20,000 = \$70,000$; paying more than the reduction loses value.
B	Dropped element	Ignores the residual ALE that remains after the control.
C	Wrong stem number	The residual ALE, not the reduction.
D	Inverted operation	Adds the ALEs instead of subtracting.

7. Answer A Concept 4

An insurance company has modern email filtering and endpoint protection, yet staff keep approving fake invoice requests. Employees complete a 20-minute training each January. ~~The company recently moved to a new headquarters building.~~ What should the strategy change first?

Target word: the lever that addresses human-driven incidents **Decides:** The failure is behavioral; tools are already in place.

A	Correct	Culture and easy secure processes change behavior; a yearly module does not.
B	Camouflage	The move does not decide the invoice-fraud issue.
C	Adjacent category	Adds technology to a people-and-process problem.
D	Absolute language	One-time training fades; no single fix fully solves it.

8. Answer B Concept 5

A university security office writes a document that says all laptops must use full-disk encryption with AES-256 and names the approved tool. ~~The document was drafted over the summer by two analysts.~~ What type of document is this?

Target word: classify the document **Decides:** Specific, mandatory technical requirement.

A	Adjacent category	Policy states intent at a high level, not the algorithm or tool.
B	Correct	Standards give specific mandatory requirements that support a policy.
C	Confusion set	Guidelines are recommendations; this says "must."
D	Dropped element	A procedure would give step-by-step instructions to do the encryption.

9. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

Which statement belongs in a policy rather than in a standard or procedure?

Target word: reverse: pick the policy-level statement **Decides:** Policy states management intent at a high level.

A	Confusion set	Step-by-step instructions: a procedure.
B	Correct	High-level, mandatory statement of intent.
C	Adjacent category	Specific technical requirement: a standard.
D	Inverted operation	“Should” marks an optional guideline, not a mandatory policy.

10. Answer D Concept 6

A manufacturer relies on a strong firewall at the network edge. It has no log review and no tested restore process. ~~The firewall appliance cost \$85,000 and was installed by a well-known integrator.~~ Which gap is most important to name in the strategy?

Target word: missing control functions **Decides:** Only preventive control exists; detective and corrective are absent.

A	Inverted operation	The firewall is preventive; the missing ones are the other functions.
B	Absolute language	No single control stops all threats.
C	Camouflage	Price and installer do not decide; the gap is missing layers.
D	Correct	Defense in depth needs layers across control functions.

11. Answer C Concept 7

A city government using NIST CSF 2.0 assigns executive roles for cybersecurity, sets its risk appetite, and requires suppliers to meet security terms. ~~The city’s population grew 6% this decade.~~ Which function do these activities belong to?

Target word: place activities in a CSF function **Decides:** Roles, risk appetite, and supply-chain policy are governance outcomes.

A	Inverted operation	Respond acts after an incident; these are set in advance.
B	Adjacent category	Identify covers asset and risk understanding, not setting roles and appetite.
C	Correct	Govern covers strategy, roles, risk appetite, and supply-chain risk management.
D	Confusion set	Protect covers safeguards like access control and training.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A gap analysis at a mid-size bank shows no multifactor authentication for remote access (high risk, low cost), an aging SIEM (medium risk, high cost), and an interest in an AI threat-hunting tool ~~a vendor demoed at a golf outing.~~ Budget covers only one item this quarter. What belongs first on the roadmap?

Target word: sequence by risk and cost **Decides:** Highest risk reduction for lowest cost.

A	Dropped element	Ignores the one-item budget limit.
B	Camouflage	Novelty and a vendor demo do not decide priority.
C	Correct	High risk reduced at low cost is the clear first move.
D	Inverted operation	Cost is not risk; this has lower risk and higher cost.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Quantitative risk: SLE, ARO, ALE	$SLE = \text{asset value} \times \text{exposure factor}$; $ALE = SLE \times ARO$ (expected yearly occurrences).	Multiplying the full asset value by ARO, or stopping at SLE.	An asset value, a percentage of loss, and a “once every N years.”
2	Risk treatment options	Mitigate reduces likelihood or impact; transfer shifts financial impact (insurance, contracts); avoid stops the activity; accept is a documented decision to live with it.	Calling cyber insurance mitigation, or calling ignoring a risk “acceptance.”	An action taken on a risk, and a question asking what kind of response it is.
3	Cost-justifying a control	A control is worth it when the ALE reduction exceeds its annual cost: $\text{value} = ALE \text{ before} - ALE \text{ after} - \text{annual control cost}$.	Comparing the control’s cost to the residual ALE, or ignoring the control’s cost.	ALE before, ALE after, and a yearly control price.
4	People and culture as a risk factor	Most breaches involve human action; lasting reduction comes from culture, ongoing reinforcement, and easy secure paths — not a single annual training.	Treating security as purely a technology purchase.	Repeated user-driven incidents despite strong tools.
5	Policy, standard, procedure, guideline	Policy states management’s intent and is mandatory; standards set specific mandatory requirements; procedures give step-by-step instructions; guidelines are recommended, not required.	Putting step-by-step instructions or specific settings into a policy.	“Must” vs. “should,” and how specific the document is.
6	Layered controls by function and type	Defense in depth combines preventive, detective, and corrective controls across administrative, technical, and physical types so no single failure exposes the asset.	Relying on one strong preventive control.	A question asking what kind of control something is, or what is missing.
7	Framework alignment (NIST CSF)	NIST CSF 2.0 organizes outcomes into Govern, Identify, Protect, Detect, Respond, Recover; Govern sets strategy, roles, and risk appetite.	Treating the framework as a technical checklist or a certification.	An activity to be placed in a function.
8	Roadmapping from a gap analysis	A roadmap compares current state to a target state tied to business risk and sequences work by risk reduction, dependency, and cost — reported to leaders in business terms.	Prioritizing by newest technology or by what vendors pitch.	Several initiatives competing for a limited budget.

Course scope (public description): Cybersecurity Strategy approaches an organization’s cybersecurity needs from a management perspective. The student will analyze a wide range of threats to cybersecurity such as policies, people, and culture as well as technology. The student will evaluate the costs and investment while road

mapping an organization's cybersecurity plan. This is strictly from a strategic perspective, however, and the learner will not be expected to implement actual solutions or perform technical tasks. There are no prerequisites for this course.